

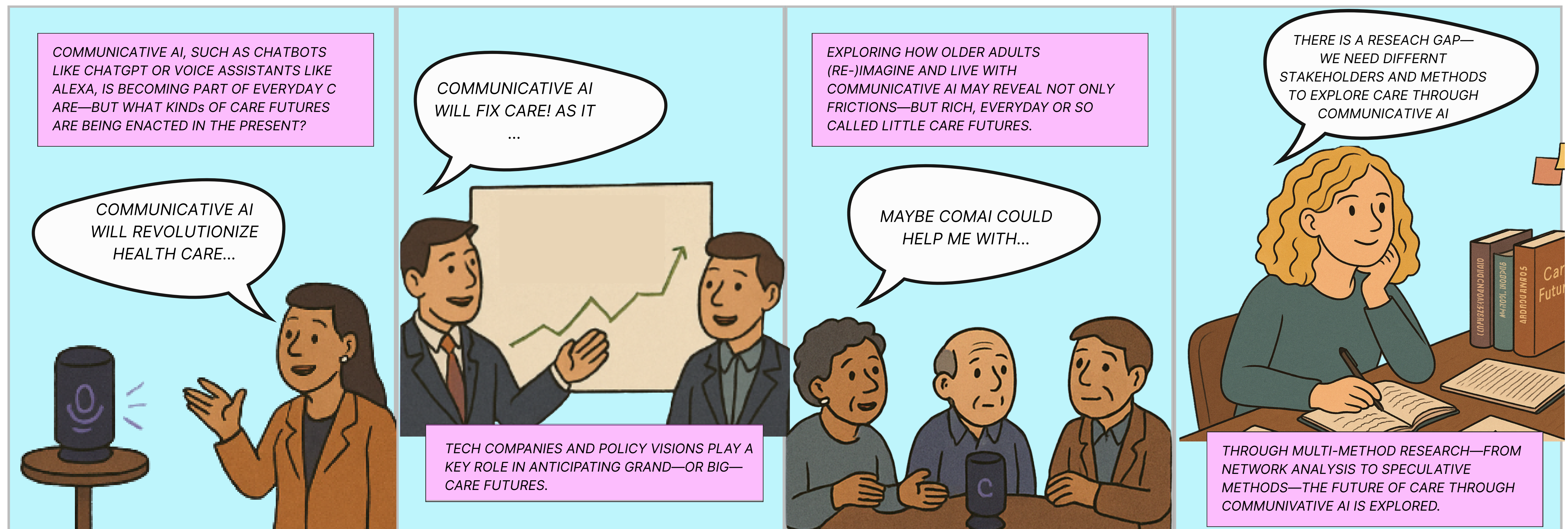
Care through Communicative AI: *Care futures-in-the-making*



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Background

This thesis explores how the future of care through Communicative AI is anticipated and imagined. Grounded in Science and Technology Studies (STS), it builds on the premise that futures are actively enacted in the present through anticipatory regimes (Adams, 2009). Drawing on Mike Michael's conceptual lens of *Big and Little Futures* (2017), the research examines the diverse visions emerging around Communicative AI in care contexts. These include grand, overarching narratives (Big Futures), as well as more modest, everyday imaginaries (Little Futures), both of which play an important role in shaping the socio-technical trajectories of care technologies.

Aim

The aim of this thesis is to investigate how the future of care through Communicative AI is anticipated and enacted in the present. It asks: What anticipations and imaginaries of care through Communicative AI are emerging? The research critically reflects on methodological triangulation and the assemblages that constitute care *futures-in-the-making*, while also engaging with conceptualizations of care. In doing so, the thesis aims to contribute to debates in STS, critical care and ageing studies, data studies, and future studies.

Methods

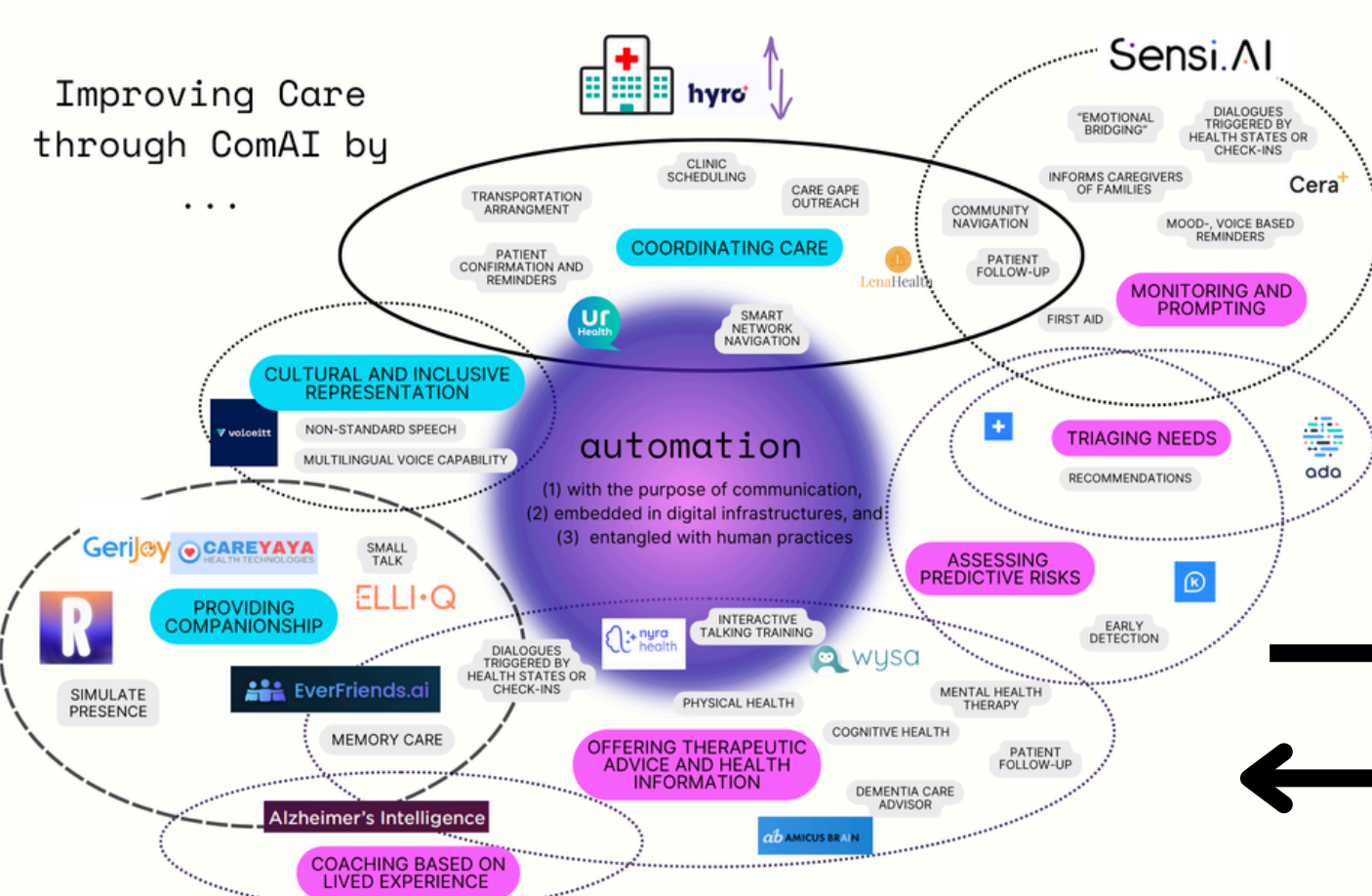
Big Care Futures

• Step a: Innovation landscape

Which aspects of care do healthcare technology companies seek to automate?

Data collection and preparation

- used *wget* to download live websites
 - accessed archived sites via *Wayback Machine* if offline
 - Batch-converted HTML files to PDFs using Google Chrome
 - imported into
- 63 identified ComAI healthcare technology companies (often just a feature)



• Step b: Policy document analysis

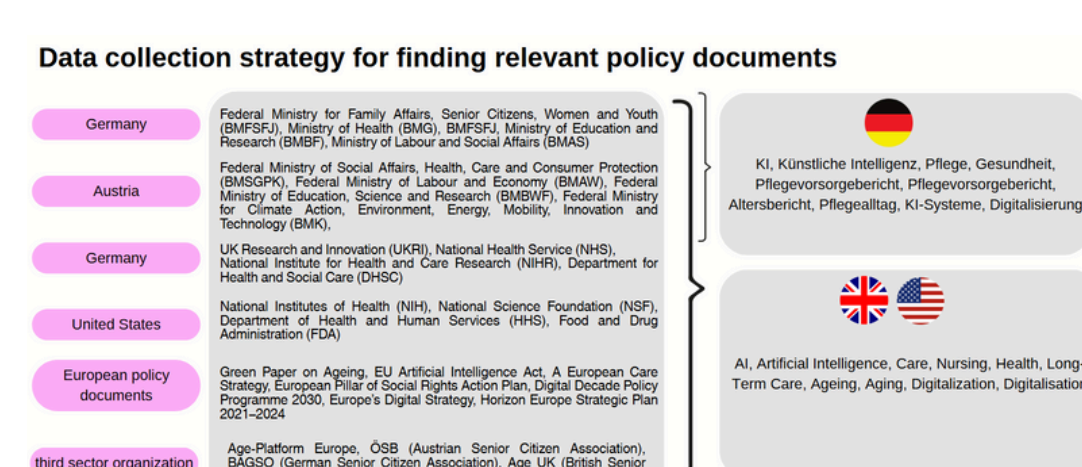
Which anticipations regarding care through ComAI are articulated and contested across different national policy contexts?

Data preparation and collection

- 132 public “policy” documents
- Jan 2018 - May 2025
- Various data types

Data analysis

- multi-method analysis: computational text analysis; interpretive policy mapping



Little Care Futures

• Step c: Participatory research

How do older adults experience care through ComAI - and where do frictions emerge regarding political anticipations?

Participatory research design

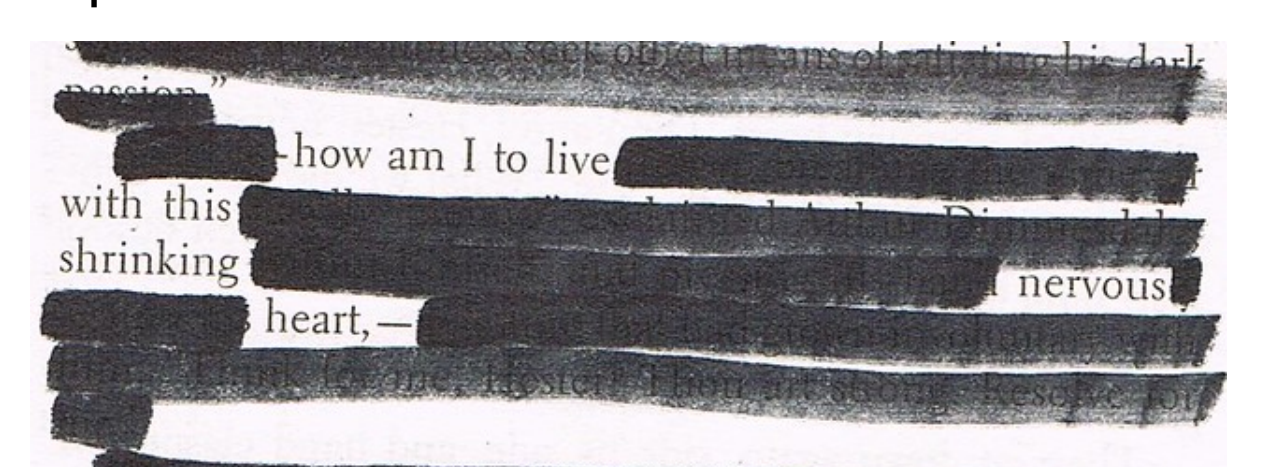
- involvement of older adults as co-researchers
- the analytical framework remains intentionally left open at this point, as it will be co-developed with older co-researchers as part of the participatory research process

• Step d: Speculative intervention

How can speculative methods be used to critically reflect on big care futures of ComAI articulated in national policy?

Workshop-style sessions

- spaces for re-imagining Care through ComAI
- as analytical interventions to reflect upon anticipations



References

Michael, Mike. 2017. „Enacting Big Futures, Little Futures: Toward an Ecology of Futures“. *The Sociological Review* 65(3):509–24. doi:10.1111/1467-954X.12444.

Adams, Vincanne, Michelle Murphy, und Adele E. Clarke. 2009. „Anticipation: Technoscience, Life, Affect, Temporality“. *Subjectivity* 28(1):246–65. doi:10.1057/sub.2009.18.

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Researching the Automation of
Societal Communication

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